

using a legacy application is a need – such as an accounting application, which can work on a Windows 98 and probably on a Windows XP machine but not on Windows Vista or 7, and at other times it would just bring back the “good old days” feeling – the little old games we mentioned. Doesn’t matter what it is you need your legacy applications for, virtualization is the way to go. That’s because there’s no way you’d be able to install Windows 98 on a modern computer for it can’t run on multi-core platforms, or 64 bit or SATA disks or a large screen! Virtualization is the charmer if you’re in need of legacy applications and a legacy OS.

If you have a powerful enough computer and VMware Workstation, you might just enjoy the old games we mentioned! VirtualBox should too do fine. Just remember to switch on the 2D and 3D acceleration!

A mini network setup

This one is for those inquisitive minds who keep trying new things. Though you can be an expert of your desktop computer and you don’t need virtualization for anything we mentioned till now in this chapter, networking is something you can’t do without having more than a single computer. If you’re one of those who have a taste for networking, love running port scans, using netcat and packet sniffers, analyzing the traffic, trying out techniques to protect your computer and have the zeal inside you to learn the art but don’t have more than one computer – you have the solution here!

Use the virtualization software of your choice to create more than a single virtual machine, install the desired operating systems in them, the required software and you’re more than ready to go. You have two computers and a network connecting them. Your guest operating systems are never going to know you fooled them!

Now, we can’t guide you to setup the network in detail and the problems you might face will differ from one virtualization software to another as well as across their different versions. We would however tell you that you need to set up an “internal network” for your virtual machines which you’re going to use for the networking purpose. VMware comes with a “virtual network manager” which will help you with that. If you’re using Qemu/KVM, the process is going to be a little difficult and here are two links to help you with networking part: <http://wiki.qemu.org/Documentation/Networking> and <http://en.wikibooks.org/wiki/QEMU/Networking> read them and you should be able to proceed a little further; do refer to man pages as well – they have a lot of info you want to have a look at!

